

Kryptos K4: The Wonderful Painted Chest & Carter's Magnificent Robe

Dear fellow code breakers. October 31st 2025 seems a wonderful day to release an enigma on the world, and we are in a race against time. I can't do it alone.

Skip to Page 4 if you do not need a history lesson – but you will need history to solve K4. While I cannot reveal any partial plaintext solutions for fear of reprisal from the creator of Kryptos itself (*history proves itself*) I will release to you the process by which to begin decrypting K4, which I discovered as originally intended. Not through use of a computer, nor through artificial intelligence, but by picking up a book and reading it in a library (...then on a computer...) As Sanborn intended, all the way back in 1990.

Skip to the last page, should you be filled with doubt at the outset.

KRYPTOS CIPHER TEXT ON FOUR PANELS (Wikipedia).

EMUFPHZLRFAXYUSDJKZLDKRNSHGNFIVJ YQTQUXQBQVYUULLTREVJYQTMKYRDMFD VFPJUDEEHZWETZYVGWHKKQETGQJNCE GGWHKK?DQMCQFQZDQMMIAGPFXHQRLG TIMVMZJANQLVKQEDAGDVFRPJUNGEUNA QZGZLECGYUXUEENJTBJLBQCRTBJDFHRR YIZETKZEMVDUFKSJHKFWHKUQLSZFTI HHDDUVH?DWKBFUFPWNTDFIYCUQZERE EVLDKFEZMQQJLTTUGSYQPFUNLAVIDX FLGGTEZ?FKZBSFDQVGOGIPUFXXHDKRF FHQNTGPAECNUVPDQMQLQUMUNEDFQ ELZZVRRGKFFVOEEXBDMVPNFQXEZLRE DNQFMNPZGLFLPMRJQYALMGNUVPDXVKP DQUMEBEDMHDAFMJGZNUPLGEWJLLAETG ENDYAHROHNL SRHEOCPTOIBIDYSHNAIA CHTNREYULDSLLSLLNOHSNOSMRWXMNE TPRNGATIHNRARPESLNNELEBLPIIACAE WMTWNDITEENRAHCTENEUDRETNAEOE TFOLSEDTIWENHAEIOYTEYQHEENCTAYCR EIFTBRSPAMHHEWENATAMATEGYEERLB TEEFOASF IOTUETUAEO TOARMAEERTNRTI BSEDDNIAAHTTMSTEWPIEROAGRIEWFEB AECTDDHILCEIHSITEGOEASODDRYLORIT RKLMLHAGTDHARDPNEOHMGFMFEUHE ECDMRIPFEIMEHNLSSSTRVDOHW?OBKR UOXOGHULBSOLIFBBWFLRVQQPRNGKSSO TWTQJQSSEKZZWATJKLUDIAWINFBNYP VTTMZFPKWGDKZXTJCDIGKUHAUEKCAR	ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ AKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ BRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ CYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ DPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ ETOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ FOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ GSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ HABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ IBCFEGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ JCDEFEGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ KDEFEGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ LEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ MFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ NGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ OHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ PIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ QJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ RLMNQVWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ SMNQVWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ TNQVWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ UQVWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ VUWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ WVWXYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ XWYZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ YXZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ ZZKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQ ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ	Cipher Method: Vigenère Keyword: cipher alphabet KRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ and cipher key PALIMPSEST Plaintext Solution: BETWEEN SUBTLE SHADING AND THE ABSENCE OF LIGHT LIES THE NUANCE OF IQLUSION Code breaker's note: PALIMPSEST: a manuscript or piece of writing material on which the original writing has been effaced to make room for later writing but of which traces remain. Something reused, altered but still bearing visible traces of its earlier form.
---	--	---

Morse code inscription on site of CIA installation (Wikipedia)

Translations of Morse code (K0) on copper slabs when read facing south, on the grounds of the CIA headquarters.

E E VIRTUALLY E E E E E E INVISIBLE	DIGITAL E E E INTERPRETATIT	E E SHADOW E E FORCES E E E E E
LUCID E E E MEMORY E	T IS YOUR POSITION E	SOS

Plaintext Solutions from Section 1, 2 and 3 of the FOUR KRYPTOS PANELS (Wikipedia).

EMUFPHZLRFAXYUSDJKZLDRKNSHGNIIVJ YQTQXQBQVYUULLTREVJYQTMKYRDMFD VFPJUDEEHZWETZYVGVHKKQETGFQJNCE GGWHKK?DQMC PFQZDQMMIAGPFHXHQLG TIMVMZJANQLVKQEDAGDVFRPJUNGEUNA QZGZLECGYUXUEENJTBJLBQCRTBJDFHRR YIZETKZEMVDFKJSHKFWHKUWQLSZFTI HHDDDUVH?DWKBFUFPWNTDFIYCUQZERE EVLDFKFEZMOQJLTTUGSYQPFUNLAVIDX FLGGTEZ?FKZBSFDQVGOGIPUFXHHDRKF FHQNTGUAECNUVPDQMCLQUMUNEDFQ ELZZVRRGKFFVOEEXBDMVFNQXEZLGRE DNQFMPNZGLFLPMRJQYALMGNUVPDXVKP DQUMEBEDMHDAFMJGZNUPLGEWJLLAETG ENDYAHROHNL SRHEOCPTEOIBIDYSHNAIA CHTNREYULDSLLSLNOSHNSOMRWXMNE TPRNGATIHNRARPESLNNLEBLPIIACAE WMTWNDITEENRAHCTENEUDRETNHAEOE TFOLSEDTIWENHAEIOYTEYQHEENCTAYCR EIFTBRSPAMHHEWENATAMATEGYEERLB TEEFOASF IOTUETUAEOOARMAEERTNRTI BSEDDNIAAHTTMSTEWPIEROAGRIEFEB AECTDDHILCEIHSITEGOEAOSSDDRYDLORI RKLMLEHAGTDHARDPNEOHMGFMFEUHE ECDMRIPFEIMEHNLSSSTRTVDOHW? UOXOGHULBSOLIFB3WFLRVQQPRNGKSSO TWTQSQSSEKZZWATJKLUDIAWINFBNYP VTTMZFPKWGDKZXTJCDIGKUHUAUEKCAR	ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZ AKRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPT BRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPT CYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTO DPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOS ETOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSA FOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSAB GSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABC HABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCD IBCDFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDE JCDFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF KDFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF LEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF MFGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF NGHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF OHIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF PIJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF QJLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF RLMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF SMNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF TNQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF UQUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF VUVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF WVWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF XWXZKRYPTOSABCDEF YXZKRYPTOSABCDEF ZZKRYPTOSABCDEF ABCDEFGHIJKLMNOPQRSTUVWXYZABCD	Cipher Method: Vigenère Cipher alphabet <i>KRYPTOSABCDEFGHIJLMNQUVWXZ</i> and cipher key <i>ABSCISSA</i>
		Plaintext Solution: <i>BETWEEN SUBTLE SHADING AND THE ABSENCE OF LIGHT LIES THE NUANCE OF IQLUSION</i>
		Code breaker's note: ABSCISSA: the horizontal x-axis of a two-dimensional graph, which, along with the y-coordinate, precisely defines the location of a point on a plan.

Cipher Method: Transposition

Cipher key: 0362514 (KRYPTOS)

Plaintext Solution:

SLOWLY DESPARATLY SLOWLY THE REMAINS OF PASSAGE DEBRIS THAT
ENCUMBERED THE LOWER PART OF THE DOORWAY WAS REMOVED WITH
TREMBLING HANDS I MADE A TINY BREACH IN THE UPPER LEFT HAND CORNER AND
THEN WIDENING THE HOLE A LITTLE I INSERTED THE CANDLE AND PEERED IN THE
HOT AIR ESCAPING FROM THE CHAMBER CAUSED THE FLAME TO FLICKER BUT
PRESENTLY DETAILS OF THE ROOM WITHIN EMERGED FROM THE MIST X CAN YOU
SEE ANYTHING Q ?

The Finding of the Tomb

Then, in the middle of the afternoon, thirty feet down from the outer door, we came upon a second sealed doorway, almost an exact replica of the first. The seal impressions in this case were less distinct, but still recognizable as those of Tut-ankh-Amen and of the royal necropolis. Here again the signs of opening and re-closing were clearly marked upon the plaster. We were firmly convinced by this time that it was a cache that we were about to open, and not a tomb. The arrangement of stairway, entrance passage and doors reminded us very forcibly of the cache of Akh-en-Aten and Tyi material found in the very near vicinity of the present excavation by Davis, and the fact that Tut-ankh-Amen's seals occurred there likewise seemed almost certain proof that we were right in our conjecture. We were soon to know. There lay the sealed doorway, and behind it was the answer to the question.

Slowly, desperately slowly it seemed to us as we watched, the remains of passage debris that encumbered the lower part of the doorway were removed, until at last we had the whole door clear before us. The decisive moment had arrived. With trembling hands I made a tiny breach in the upper left hand corner. Darkness and blank space, as far as an iron testing-rod could reach, showed that whatever lay beyond was empty, and not filled like the passage we had just cleared. Candle tests were applied as a precaution against possible foul gases, and then widening the hole a little, I inserted the candle and peered in, Lord Carnarvon, Lady Evelyn and Callender standing anxiously beside me to hear the verdict. At first I could see nothing, the hot air escaping from the chamber causing the candle flame to flicker, but

93

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

presently, as my eyes grew accustomed to the light, details of the room within emerged slowly from the mist, strange animals, statues, and gold—everywhere the glint of gold. For the moment—an eternity it must have seemed to the others standing by—I was struck dumb with amazement, and when Lord Carnarvon, unable to stand the suspense any longer, inquired anxiously, "Can you see anything?" it was all I could do to get out the words, "Yes, wonderful things." Then widening the hole a little further, so that we both could see, we inserted an electric torch.

Code breaker's introduction:

For the Kryptos community, this is where we move away from an area of highly studied content, to an area that, in 35 years, no one has studied or documented.

This is Jim Sanborn, the artist, coming out, showing his love for the discovery of the Tomb and the treasures inside and marrying it with a cipher.

The photographs at left refer to *The Tomb of Tut-Ankh-Amen*, as documented and discovered by the *Late Earl of Carnarvon and Howard Carter*.

This document has rarely been OCR'd correctly, and to date no code breaker has given this manuscript a top to bottom read and found the correct sections, approximately 100 pages later (more if you include the annexes of photographic record). Since 2010, this document has shown up on Archive.org, but has been very poorly OCR'd. Here are searchable references on [Archive.org I](#) and [Archive.org II](#)

You will find this studied on the next page, but before you continue I must explain that an approach has been applied to discern a significant portion of the K4 plaintext using a novel method described herein, which is not difficult to replicate—especially not for my friends in Kryptos circles.

Instead of seeking fame or interfering with the auction of the K4 plaintext coming next month, I am instead sharing this critical decipherment process so that the Kryptos community, and the thousands of codebreakers that have looked at Kryptos since 1990, can appreciate the artistry Sanborn was aiming for.

Sanborn installed Kryptos at a time when he expected sleuths to visit a library, pick up a book, and read it for clues. That's why all previous attempts at this deciphering this passage have failed.

Prepare yourself, then get to work! For you are about to see **wonderful things!**

It's been waiting for us all along, but we were looking so hard at this passage we forgot to explore exactly what happens inside the tomb.

Work in the Laboratory

until they should be wanted. Each in turn was brought up to the working bay for examination. There, after the surface dust had been cleared off, measurements, complete archaeological notes, and copies of inscriptions were entered on the filing cards. The necessary mending and preservative treatment followed, after which it was taken just outside the entrance for scale photographs to be made. Finally, having passed through all these stages, the object was stored away in the innermost recesses of the tomb to await the final packing.

In the majority of cases no attempt at final treatment was made. It was manifestly impossible, for months, probably years, of reconstructive work are necessary if full use is to be made of the material. All we could do here was to apply preliminary treatment, sufficient in any event to enable the object to support a journey in safety. Final restorations must be made in the museum, and they will need a far more fully equipped laboratory and a much larger staff of skilled helpers than we could ever hope to achieve in The Valley.

As the season advanced, and the laboratory grew more and more crowded, it became increasingly difficult to keep track of the work, and it was only by close attention to detail, and strict adherence to a very definite order of procedure, that we managed to keep clear of complications. As each object arrived its registration number was noted in an entry book, and in the same book a record was kept of the successive stages of its treatment. Each of the primary objects had been given its own registration number in the tomb, but as these were worked over in the laboratory an elaborate system

163

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

of sub-numbering became necessary. A box, for instance, might contain fifty objects, any one of which must be clearly identifiable at all times, and these we distinguished by letters of the alphabet, or, where necessary, by a combination of letters. Constant care was necessary to keep these smaller objects from being separated from their identification tickets, especially in cases where protracted treatment was required. Not infrequently it happened that the component parts of a single object, scattered in the tomb, were entered under two or more numbers, and in this case cross-references in the notes were necessary. Note-cards, as completed, were filed away in cabinets, and in these filing cabinets we had, by the end of the season, a complete history of every object from the tomb, including :—

- (1) Measurements, scale drawings, and archaeological notes.
- (2) Notes on the inscriptions by Dr. Alan Gardiner.
- (3) Notes by Mr. Lucas on the preservative treatment employed.
- (4) A photograph, showing the position of the object in the tomb.
- (5) A scale photograph, or series of photographs, of the object itself.
- (6) In the case of boxes, a series of views, showing the different stages in the clearing.

So much for our system of work. Let us turn now to the individual treatment of a selected number of the antiquities. The first that required treatment in the laboratory was the wonderful painted casket (No. 21 in our register), and, if we had searched

164

Code breaker's note: Let's go. We begin exactly seventy pages later in this specific version of Howard Carter's account of **the opening of the Tomb of Tutankhamen (first volume of three, first edition, reprinted 2010, OCR'd 2017, OCR re-map 2019).**

At this point, Carter has explored the first portions of the tomb and certain artifacts are being brought back for study.

I will use two styles of inserting helpful guidance to you.

- Direct **[GREEN]** Code breaker's notes
- Indirect **[ORANGE]** in-line assistance

Page 163:...it became increasingly difficult to keep track of the work, and it was only by close attention to detail *[hint from Sanborn]*, and strict adherence to a very definite order of procedure *[follow these steps that will be revealed to a "T"]*, that we managed to keep clear of complications.....Each of the primary objects had been given its own registration number in the tomb, but ... an elaborate system of sub-numbering became necessary. *[You must address the subsystem].*

Page 164: ...A box, for instance, might contain fifty objects, any one of which must be clearly identifiable at all times, and these we distinguished by letters of the alphabet, or, where necessary, by a combination of letters *[a literal nod from Sanborn that we have now arrived where he intended]*...Not infrequently it happened that the component parts of a single object, scattered in the tomb, were entered under two or more numbers, and in this case cross-references in the notes were necessary. *[Throughout Carter's account, various photographic evidence will be important to come back to].*

So much for our system of work. *[Sanborn's ciphersystem for K4]* Let us turn now to the individual treatment of a selected number of the antiquities *[the decipherment process that is about to be described]*.

The first that required treatment in the laboratory was the **wonderful painted casket** (No. 21 in our register)...*[a final nod that we're on the right track.]*

Code breaker's note: I must spoil some surprise now loyal readers and fellow cryptographers, Kryptos is in fact the "**wonderful painted casket**" and antiquity number 21 in Carter's register is in fact K4, which Carter calls *the magnificent robe*.

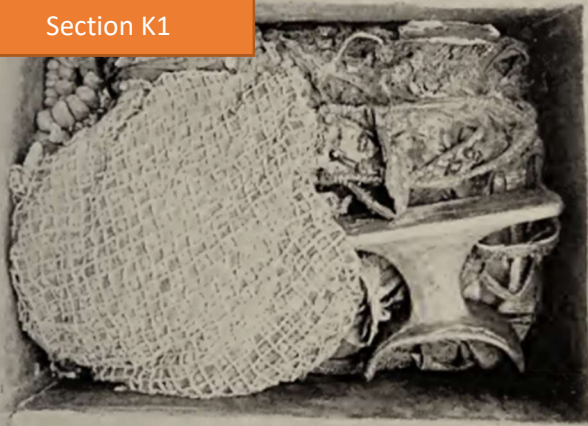
Sanborn was pointing to it all along. K3 ends with the question: *Can you see anything?* The answer Carter gave in his account of the tomb was: "*Yes, wonderful things.*" Although the word wonderful appears elsewhere in the approximate 230-page manuscript, there is **only one place you need to concentrate on for solving K4 at this time** – and it's not when Carter answers that question a third of the way through his account, but when he describes **the wonderful painted casket and what he found inside** – a literal palimpsest of treasures.

Code breaker's note: In order to appreciate what you're about to see and learn, take the time to study this box and the below images closely. There are lovely, high definition current photographs online of the original items, as well as the critical reconstruction of the mysterious robe.

Carter photographed four stages of opening the **"wonderful painted casket"** [aka Kryptos itself, as a whole]. Inside, there was a great deal of individual treasures – **only one of which is important to you right now** – the magnificent robe.

The images themselves were photographed and labelled A, B, C, D, literally showing the stages of unpacking the **"wonderful painted casket"** aka Kryptos. It is a direct echo of K1, K2, K3, and K4, which I will describe next.

Section K1



A

Section K2



B

PLATE XXXIV

PAINTED CASKET, No. 21.

Series showing the unpacking. First (A) and second (B) stages.

Section K3



C

Section K4, and what remains below: K5/K0



D

PLATE XXXV

PAINTED CASKET, No. 21.

Series showing the unpacking. Third (C) and fourth (D) stages.

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

Drastic measures were necessary, and after much discussion we decided on the use of melted paraffin wax. Courage was needed to take the step, but we were thoroughly justified by the result, for the wax penetrated the materials and held everything firm, and, so far from the colours being affected, as we had feared, it seemed to make them more brilliant than before. We used this process later on a number of other objects of wood and gesso, and found it extremely satisfactory. It is important that the surface should be heated, and that the wax should be brought as near to boiling-point as possible; otherwise it will chill and refuse to penetrate. Failing an oven we found the Egyptian sun quite hot enough for the purpose. Surplus wax can be removed by the application of heat, or by the use of benzine. There is another advantage in the process, in that blisters in the gesso can be pressed down into place again while the wax is still warm, and will hold quite firmly. In very bad cases it may be necessary to fill the blister in from behind by means of hot wax applied by a pipette.

So much for the outside of the casket. Now let us remove the lid and see what the inside has in store for us. This is an exciting moment, for there are beautiful things everywhere, and, thanks to the hurried re-packing carried out by the officials, there is nothing to forewarn one as to what the contents of any individual box may be. In this particular case, by reference to the four views on Plates XXXIV and XXXV, the reader can himself follow the successive stages in the clearing, and it will give him some idea of the difficulty of handling the material if I explain that it took me three weeks of hard work to get

Page 165: *Drastic measures were necessary...Courage was needed to take the step, but we were thoroughly justified by the result...We used this process later on a number of other objects of wood and gesso*

So much for the outside of the casket. [Kryptos as a whole]. Now let us remove the lid and see what the inside has in store for us. This is an exciting moment, for there are beautiful things everywhere...there is nothing to forewarn one as to what the contents of any individual box [or cipher within] may be.

In this particular case, by reference to the four views on Plates XXXIV and XXXV, the reader can himself follow the successive stages in the clearing [the process of going through K1 through K4, and it will give him some idea of the difficulty of handling the material [K5] if I explain that it took me three weeks of hard work to get to the bottom of the box [K5 again; Kryptos as a whole].

Code breaker's notes:

- "beautiful things everywhere" is harkening back to Carter's "Wonderful things statement," this is a Sanborn clue.
- The "four views" refers to the photographed stages of uncovering on the previous page, which when combined will grant you access to successive stages of the Kryptos solution, and what sits on the bottom of the buried contents.

Take a deep breath now! We're uncovering the secret just like Carter did, just like Sanborn intended with Kryptos.

Work in the Laboratory

to the bottom of the box. The first photograph was taken immediately after the lid had been removed, and before anything was touched. On the right there is a pair of rush and papyrus sandals, in perfect condition; below them, just showing, a gilt head-rest, and, lower again, a confused mass of cloth, leather, and gold, of which we can make nothing as yet. On the left, crumpled into a bundle, there is a magnificent royal robe, and in the upper corner there are roughly shaped beads of dark resin. The robe it was that presented us with our first problem, a problem that was constantly to recur—how best to handle cloth that crumbled at the touch, and yet was covered with elaborate and heavy decoration. In this particular case the whole surface of the robe is covered with a network of faience beads, with a gold sequin filling in every alternate square in the net. These—beads and sequins—had originally been sewn to the cloth, but are now loose. A great many of them are upside down, the releasing of the tension when the thread snapped having evidently caused them to spring. At the borders of the robe—they are underneath, and do not show in the photograph—there are bands of tiny glass beads of various colours, arranged in patterns. The upper layer of cloth was very deceptive in appearance. It looked reasonably solid, but if one tried to lift it, it fell to pieces in one's hand. Below, where it had been in contact with other things, the condition was much worse.

This question of cloth and its treatment was enormously complicated for us in the present tomb by the rough usage to which it had been subjected. Had it been spread out flat, or neatly folded, it

Page 167: *The first photograph was taken immediately after the lid had been removed, and before anything was touched.*

Layers of the palimpsest:

1. *On the right there is a pair of rush and papyrus sandals, in perfect condition [K1: palimpsest; the sandals were not in perfect condition, but were reconstructed back in the lab].*
2. *below them, just showing, gilt head-rest [K2: just showing, and discernable as vignere]*
3. *lower again, a confused mass of cloth, leather, and gold, of which we can make nothing as yet. [K3: columnar transposition merely reveals the plaintext of K3, but this plaintext alone is not enough on its own to decipher K4]*
4. *On the left, crumpled into a bundle, there is a magnificent royal robe, and in the upper corner there are roughly shaped beads of dark resin. [K4]*

Code breaker's notes: K4 has finally been found in the wonderful painted chest. The magnificent royal robe.

Page 167: *The robe it was that presented us with our first problem, a problem that was constantly to recur—how best to handle cloth that crumbled at the touch [palimpsest], and yet was covered with elaborate and heavy decoration [letters]. In this particular case the whole surface of the robe [K4] is covered with a network of faience beads [cipher component a], with a gold sequin [cipher component b] filling in every alternate square in the net. [process key i]. These—beads and sequins—had originally been sewn to the cloth [K4], but are now loose [and jumbled up; the ciphertext]. A great many of them are upside down [process key ii]...At the borders of the robe—they are underneath, and do not show in the photograph [process key iii]—there are bands of tiny glass beads of various colours, arranged in patterns [process key iv]. The upper layer of cloth was very deceptive in appearance. It looked reasonably solid, but if one tried to lift it, it fell to pieces in one's hand.*

Code breaker's notes: Sanborn is literally using Carter's account to describe Kryptos as a whole and the K4 process here.

Page 167: *Below, where it had been in contact with other things, the condition was much worse [part of K4 continues beyond the end of the ciphertext; the bottom of the sculpture touching the ground has something buried below it and hidden]. This question of cloth and its treatment was enormously complicated for us in the present tomb [we must now move away from K3 into K4]. Had it been spread out flat, or neatly folded, it would have been a comparatively simple matter to deal with it.*

Code breaker's notes: I hope I have your attention now. Sanborn was talking directly to us through Carter's words for 35 years – we missed it.

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

would have been a comparatively simple matter to deal with it. We should, as a matter of fact, have had an easier task if it had been allowed to remain strewn about the floor of the chamber, as the plunderers had left it. Nothing could have been worse for our purposes than the treatment it had undergone in the tidying-up process, in which the various garments had been crushed, bundled and interfolded, and packed tightly into boxes with a mixture of other and, in some cases, most incongruous objects.

In the case of this present robe it would have been perfectly simple to solidify the whole of the upper layer and remove it in one piece, but this was a process to which there were serious objections. It involved, firstly, a certain amount of danger to whatever might lie beneath, for in the unpacking of these boxes we had to be continually on our guard lest, in our enthusiasm over the treatment or removal of an object, we might inflict damage on a still more valuable one which lay under it.

Then, again, if we made the upper part of the robe solid, we should seriously have reduced the chances of extracting evidence as to size and shape, to say nothing of the details of ornamentation. In dealing with all these robes there were two alternatives before us. Something had to be sacrificed, and we had to make up our minds whether it should be the cloth or the decoration. It would have been quite possible, by the use of preservatives, to secure large pieces of the cloth, but, in the process, we should inevitably have disarranged and damaged the bead ornamentation that lay below. On the other hand, by sacrificing the cloth, picking it carefully away

Page 168: *we should...have had an easier task if it had been allowed to remain strewn about the floor of the chamber [hint: it must be laid flat, there is also later mention of a gilded necklace laid flat and photographed]...Nothing could have been worse for our purposes than the treatment it had undergone in the tidying-up process... the various garments had been crushed, bundled and interfolded, and packed tightly into boxes with a mixture of other and, in some cases, most incongruous objects.*

Code breaker's note: This entire description is reference to the keyword **palimpsest** from K1, but also an upcoming clue with a gilded necklace.

Page 168: *In the case of this present robe it would have been perfectly simple to solidify the whole of the upper layer and remove it in one piece, but this was a process to which there were serious objections.*

Code breaker's note: the first half of this description refers to K1 and K2 being encrypted with the vignère keyword. The 'serious objections' are the varying cipher methods at play, and now we are moving into K5 territory for later, being unable to completely remove K1 and K2 from the equation after solving K3 and K4.

Page 168: *It involved, firstly, a certain amount of danger to whatever might lie beneath, for in the unpacking of these boxes we had to be continually on our guard lest, in our enthusiasm over the treatment or removal of an object, we might inflict damage on a still more valuable one which lay under it [the bottommost, fourth documented object is the magnificent robe, below it rests K5/K0].*

Page 168: *Then, again, if we made the upper part of the robe solid, we should seriously have reduced the chances of extracting evidence as to size and shape, to say nothing of the details of ornamentation.*

Code breaker's note: The ah-ha moment is below.

Page 168: *In dealing with all these robes there were two alternatives before us. Something had to be sacrificed, and we had to make up our minds whether it should be the cloth or the decoration [process key v & vi]. It would have been quite possible, by the use of preservatives, to secure large pieces of the cloth, but, in the process, we should inevitably have disarranged and damaged the bead ornamentation that lay below [process key v]. On the other hand, by sacrificing the cloth, picking it carefully away piece by piece [process key v].*

Work in the Laboratory

piece by piece, we could recover, as a rule, the whole scheme of decoration. This was the plan we usually adopted. Later, in the museum, it will be possible to make a new garment of the exact size, to which the original ornamentation—bead-work, gold sequins, or whatever it may be—can be applied. Restorations of this kind will be far more useful, and have a much greater archaeological value, than a few irregularly shaped pieces of preserved cloth and a collection of loose beads and sequins.

The size of the robe from this casket can be worked out with reasonable accuracy from the ornamentation. At the lower hem there was a band, composed of tiny beads arranged in a pattern, a pattern of which we were able to secure the exact details. From this band there hung, at equal intervals, a series of bead strings with a large pendant at the end of each string. We can thus calculate the circumference of the hem by multiplying the space between the strings by the number of pendants. That gives us the width of the robe. Now we can calculate the total area of decoration from the number of gold sequins employed, and, if we divide this total area by our known circumference at the bottom, we shall arrive at a fairly accurate approximation of the height. This naturally presupposes that our robe is the same width throughout, a method of cutting borne out by a number of undecorated garments of which we were able to secure the exact measurements.

This has been a long digression, but it was necessary, to show the nature of the problem with which we had to deal. We can return to the casket now, and really begin to explore its contents. First of

M

169

Code breaker's note:

The words "a method of cutting borne" refers that other Egyptian robes were cut in the fashion of cylinders, not cut to the shape of the body/wearer itself. A tube, in all senses of the word, top to bottom, with sleeves for arms, exactly like Kryptos. There is double meaning here as well for the decipherment. **This entire page is what you need to begin solving K4 and the rest. It is the exact process that CIA employee Edward Scheidt took and masterfully crafted into the first half of K4's cipher.**

Page 169: *we could recover, as a rule, the whole scheme of decoration [the encryption method]. This was the plan we usually adopted. Later, in the museum, it will be possible to make a new garment of the exact size [the code breaker must organize and replicate the entire ciphertext], to which the original ornamentation [encoding]—bead-work beads [cipher component a], gold sequins beads [cipher component b], or whatever it may be [pearls; cipher component a]—can be applied.*

Code breaker's note: we are now moving into the rules for K4 decipherment and describing the remaking of the magnificent robe via pen and paper – it's exact size, original ornamentation, and placement of its beads, gold sequins.

Page 169: *Restorations of this kind will be far more useful, and have a much greater archaeological value, than a few irregularly shaped pieces of preserved cloth and a collection of loose beads and sequins [all four sections, once recreated, will be used to decipher the installation, K1 through K0 as keys].*

Code breaker's note: Here it comes. I will insert words in square brackets to help you along.

Page 169: *The size of the robe [K4 cipher] from this [wonderful Kryptos] casket can be worked out with reasonable accuracy from the ornamentation [cipher components]. At the lower hem [of Kryptos, where K4 starts] there **was** a band [note the double meaning of the word 'was', it's past tense, the robe has fallen into decay – it was there, but it also marks cipher key a locations; note the beginning of K4] composed of tiny beads [cipher key a: alphabetical letters] arranged in a pattern, a pattern of which we were able to **secure** the exact details [note the word secure, it means encrypt, it means to hide the exact plaintext, but also obtain]. From this band [K4] there hung, at equal intervals, a series of bead strings [cipher component a] with a large pendant at the end of each string [cipher component c, the recurring letters].*

Code breaker's note: large pendants are BB, SS, SS, ZZ, TT and RR; a second letter added to the end—I used RR—for a clean divisible of 98.

Page 169: *We can thus calculate the circumference of the hem [Kryptos, K4 wrapped in a cylinder shape, process key vii] by multiplying the space between the strings by the number of pendants [cipher component iii]. That gives us the width of the robe [Kryptos, K4]. Now we can calculate the total area [process key viii] of decoration from the number of gold sequins employed [cipher component ii], and, if we divide this total area by our known circumference at the bottom, we shall arrive at a fairly accurate approximation of the height [K4, then K5]. This naturally presupposes that our robe [Kryptos] is the same width throughout, a method of cutting borne out by a number of undecorated garments of which we were able to **secure** the exact measurements [cipher method].*

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

all we removed the rush sandals, which were in beautifully firm condition, and presented no difficulties (Plate XXXIV, B). Next came the gilt head-rest, and then, very carefully, we removed the robe. One large portion of its upper surface we managed to take out whole by the aid of a celluloid solution, and short lengths of the band decorations of small beads we preserved in wax for future reference. The third photograph (Plate XXXV, c) shows what we may call the second layer of the casket's contents. Here, to begin with, were three pairs of sandals, or rather, to be accurate, two pairs of sandals and a pair of loose slippers. These were of leather, elaborately decorated with gold, and of wonderful workmanship (two of them are shown on Plate XXXVI). Unfortunately, their condition left much to be desired. They had suffered from their packing in the first place, but, worse than that, some of the leather had melted and run, gluing the sandals together and fastening them to other objects, making their extraction from the box a matter of extreme difficulty. So much of the leather had perished that the question of restoration became a serious problem. We secured the gold ornamentation that still remained in place with a solution of Canada balsam, and strengthened them generally as far as we could, but eventually it will probably be better to make new sandals and apply the old decoration to them. *palimpsest*

Beneath the sandals there was a mass of decayed cloth, much of it of the consistency of soot, thickly spangled throughout with rosettes and sequins of gold and silver. This, sad to relate, represents a number of royal robes. The difficulty of trying to extract any intelligible record from it can be imagined.

Page 170: Beneath the sandals there was a mass of decayed cloth, much of it of the consistency of soot [virtually invisible, we may be approaching K5/K0 and what rests below the decayed robe], thickly spangled throughout with rosettes and sequins of gold and silver. This, sad to relate, represents a number of royal robes [Another nod from Sanborn; ciphers and art lost to time – unlike Kryptos, which can be solved].

Code breaker's note: So you can sleep at night (or not) here are some final passages for your sanity, that you are walking down the correct path. You're now following the footsteps of those who came before, and you will discover something incredible.

Page 170: First of all we removed the rush sandals, which were in beautifully firm condition, and presented no difficulties [Sanborn indicate K1 would be the fastest and easiest to solve, but in fact the sandals were falling apart and palimpsest refers]. Next came the gilt head-rest [K2, following closely, there is also a photograph later], and then, very carefully, we removed the robe. [still some double meaning with K3; harder, but possible; a different method of encrypting from vignere]. One large portion of its upper surface [K1, K2, K3] we managed to take out whole by the aid of a celluloid solution, and short lengths of the band decorations of small beads [K4; cipher component a] we preserved in wax for future reference. The third photograph [where we first observed the magnificent robe as a confused mass of cloth, gold, beads and pearls] shows what we may call the second layer of the casket's contents [Kryptos' contents; the second layer; K3 and K4].

Code breaker's note: full stop. We're now examining the 'second layer,' which Sanborn had to clarify did not mean IDBYROWS. In 2005, a fellow Canadian codebreaker, Nicole Friedrich, determined the correct plaintext capping off K2 was "XLAYERTWO", as confirmed by Sanborn a year later. Sanborn omitted an S in the ciphertext (an X in the plaintext), and he confirmed that the last passage of the plaintext was "WESTXLAYERTWO", and not "WESTIDBYROWS". Focus on this, when adding the extra 98th character for diving K4 as you know understand it. Using R helps.

Page 170: Here, to begin with, were three pairs of sandals, or rather, to be accurate, two pairs of sandals and a pair of loose slippers. These were of leather, elaborately decorated with gold, and of wonderful workmanship (two of them are shown on Plate XXXVI). Unfortunately, their condition left much to be desired. They had suffered from their packing in the first place, but, worse than that, some of the leather had melted and run, gluing the sandals together and fastening them to other objects, making their extraction from the box a matter of extreme difficulty. So much of the leather had perished that the question of restoration became a serious problem. We secured the gold ornamentation that still remained in place with a solution of Canada balsam, and strengthened them generally as far as we could, but eventually it will probably be better to make new sandals and apply the old decoration to them. [This is a literal description of creating new on top of old: a palimpsest. Don't forget this later].

Page 170-171: The difficulty of trying to extract any intelligible record from it can be imagined, but a certain amount of assistance was given by the differences in the sizes and shapes of the sequins [cipher component b].

Work in the Laboratory

ined, but a certain amount of assistance was given by the differences in the sizes and shapes of the sequins. There were at least seven distinct garments. One was an imitation leopard-skin cloak in cloth, with gilt head, and spots and claws of silver (see last photograph of the series, Plate XXXV, D); while two of the others were head-dresses, made in the semblance of hawks with outstretched wings, of the type shown in Plate LXXVIII. Bundled in with the actual garments there were a number of other objects—two faience collarettes of beads and pendants, two caps or bags of tiny bead-work which had almost entirely fallen to pieces, a wooden tag inscribed in hieratic “Papyrus (?) sandals of His Majesty,” a glove of plain linen, an archer’s gauntlet, tapestry woven in coloured thread, a double necklace of large flat faience beads (see Plate XXXV, D), and a number of linen belts or scarves. Below the garments there was a layer of rolls and pads of cloth, some of which were loin-cloths and others mere bandages; and below these again, resting on the bottom of the box, there were two boards, perforated at one end for hanging, whose purpose is still doubtful.

With very few exceptions—the rush sandals are a case in point—the garments it contained were those of a child. Our first idea was that the king might have kept stored away the clothes he wore as a boy; but later, on one of the belts, and on the sequins of one of the robes, we found the royal cartouche. He must, then, have worn them after he became king, from which it would seem to follow that he was quite a young boy when he succeeded to the throne. Another interesting piece of evidence in this connexion is supplied by the fact that on

171

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

the lid of one of the other boxes there is a docket which reads, “The King’s side-lock (?) as a boy.” The question raises an interesting historical point, and we shall be eager to see, when the time comes, the evidence of age that the mummy will supply. Certainly, whenever the king appears upon the tomb furniture, he is represented as little more than a youth.

One other point with regard to the robes found in this and other boxes. Many of them are decorated with patterns in coloured linen threads. Some of these are examples of tapestry weaving, similar to the fragments found in the tomb of Thothmes IV,¹ but there were also undoubted cases of applied needlework. The material from this tomb will be of extreme importance to the history of textile art, and it needs very careful study.

We shall not have space here to describe the unpacking of the other boxes, but all were in the same jumbled state, and all had the same queer mixture of incongruous objects. Many of them contained from fifty to sixty individual pieces, each requiring its own registration card, and there was never any lack of excitement in the unpacking, for you never knew when you might not happen upon a magnificent gold scarab, a statuette, or a beautiful piece of jewellery. It was slow work, naturally, for hours at a time had to be spent working out with brush and bellows the exact order and arrangement of collar, necklace, or gold decoration, covered, as they ordinarily were, with the dust of decayed cloth. The collars were a frequent source of trouble.

¹ Carter and Newberry, *Tomb of Thoutmosis IV*, Pls. I and XXVIII, Nos. 46526–46529.

Page 171: There were at least seven distinct garments. One...in cloth (see last photograph of the series, Plate XXXV, d); while two of the others were ... shown in Plate LXXVIII. Bundled in with the actual garments there were a number of other objects—two faience collarettes of beads and pendants, two caps or bags of tiny bead-work which had almost entirely fallen to pieces, a wooden tag inscribed in hieratic “Papyrus (?) [another nod to palimpsest, with the ? as well] sandals of His Majesty,” a glove of plain linen, an archer’s gauntlet, tapestry woven in coloured thread, a double necklace of large flat faience beads (see Plate XXXV, d), and a number of linen belts or scarves.

Below the garments there was a layer of rolls and pads of cloth...and below...resting on the bottom of the box...there were **two boards, perforated at one end for hanging, whose purpose is still doubtful** [*Kryptos Panel I and Panel II; left and right; likely a nod to K5 and K0*].

Code breaker’s note: K0, may in fact, be the tool you require at the end. A lodestone and morse code to break K5. The two boards whose purpose is still doubtful is the Kryptos statue itself, both panels.

Code breaker’s note: this is where my job ends, and yours begins. You have approximately one month to use all of this information to arrive at the same conclusions I have. Solve K4, then go further than and attack Kryptos with everything you’ve learned.

Good luck!

Final clue:

Page 172: Another interesting piece of evidence in this connexion [*interesting archaic spelling in early-1900s, much like Kryptos misspellings in late 80s*] is supplied by the fact that on the lid of one of the other boxes there is a docket which reads, “The King’s side-lock (?) as a boy.” The question raises an interesting historical point, and we shall be eager to see, when the time comes, the evidence of age that the mummy will supply. **One other point with regard to the robes** found in this and other boxes. Many of them are decorated with patterns in coloured linen threads. Some of these are examples of tapestry weaving, similar to the fragments found in the tomb of Thothmes IV,¹ but there were also undoubted cases of applied needlework. The material from this tomb will be of extreme importance to the history of textile art, and it needs very careful study.

We shall not have space here to describe the unpacking of the other boxes [*because, they’re irrelevant to Kryptos*], but all were in the same jumbled state, and all had the same queer mixture of incongruous objects. Many of them contained from fifty to sixty individual pieces, each requiring its own registration card, **and there was never any lack of excitement in the unpacking, for you never knew when you might not happen upon a magnificent gold scarab, a statuette, or a beautiful piece of jewellery.**

It was slow work, naturally, for hours at a time had to be spent working out with brush and bellows [*open and paper*] **the exact order and arrangement of collar, necklace, or gold decoration, covered, as they ordinarily were, with the dust of decayed cloth** [*the cipher; plaintext*].

PLATE LXXVIII
TEXTILES OF APPLIED NEEDLEWORK

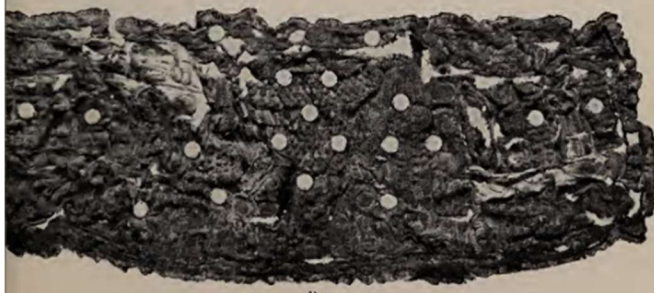
(A) Head ornament in the form of hawks' wing and decorated with gold sequins.

(B) A portion of robe with applied needlework decoration and embellished with gold sequins.

(See p. 234.)



A



B



Then came another puzzle. In the lower strata of rubbish that filled the staircase we found masses of broken potsherds and boxes, the latter bearing the names of Akh-en-Aten, Smenkh-ka-Re and Tut-ankh-Amen, and, what was much more upsetting, a scarab of Thothmes III and a fragment with the name of Amen-hetep III. Why this mixture of names? The balance of evidence so far would seem to indicate a cache rather than a tomb, and at this stage in the proceedings we inclined more and more to the opinion that we were about to find a miscellaneous collection of objects of the Eighteenth Dynasty kings, brought from Tell el Amarna by Tut-ankh-Amen and deposited here for safety.

Next I searched the seal impressions on the door for evidence of the identity of the owner, but could find no name: the only decipherable ones were those of the well-known royal necropolis seal, the jackal and nine captives. Two facts, however, were clear: first, the employment of this royal seal was certain evidence that the tomb had been constructed for a person of very high standing; and second, that the sealed door was entirely screened from above by workmen's huts of the Twentieth Dynasty was sufficiently clear proof that at least from that date it had never been entered. With that for the moment I had to be content.

While examining the seals I noticed, at the top of the doorway, where some of the plaster had fallen away, a heavy wooden lintel. Under this, to assure myself of the method by which the doorway had been blocked, I made a small peephole, just large enough to insert an electric torch, and discovered that the passage beyond the door was filled completely from floor to ceiling with stones and rubble—additional proof this of the care with which the tomb had been protected.

It was a thrilling moment for an excavator. Alone, save for my native workmen, I found myself, after years of comparatively unproductive labour, on the threshold of what might prove to be a magnificent discovery. Anything, literally anything, might lie beyond that passage, and it needed all my self-control to keep from breaking down the doorway, and investigating then and there.

One thing puzzled me, and that was the smallness of the opening in comparison with the ordinary Valley tombs. The design was certainly of the

The Tomb of Tut-ankh-Amen

for in the recovery and restoration of this bead-work every single bead will have to be handled at least twice. Very careful work will be necessary to secure the original arrangement of the beads. The threads that held them together will all have rotted away, but nevertheless they will be lying for the most part in their correct relative positions, and by carefully blowing away the dust it may be possible to follow the whole length of necklace or collar, and secure the exact order of the beads. Re-threading may be done *in situ* as each section is laid bare—on a many-stringed girdle I once had twelve needles and thread going simultaneously—or, better still, the beads may be transferred one by one to a piece of cardboard on which a thin layer of plasticine has been spread. This has the advantage that gaps of the required length can be left for missing or doubtfully placed beads.

In very elaborate objects, where it is not possible to thread the beads as they are found, careful notes must be made, the re-stringing being done later, not in exact order, bead for bead, but in accordance with the original pattern and design. A tedious business this re-stringing will be, and a good deal of experimental work will probably be necessary before you arrive at the correct method of dealing with the particular problem. In a collar, for example, it may be necessary to have three independent threading strings to every bead, if the rows are to lie smoothly in place. Restoration of missing or broken parts will sometimes be necessary if a reconstruction is to be effected. I once found a set of bracelets and anklets in which the rows of beads had been separated by perforated bars of wood covered with

160

The condition of textiles varies. Cloth in some cases is so strong that it might have come fresh from the loom, whereas in others it has been reduced by damp almost to the consistency of soot. In the present tomb the difficulty of handling it was considerably increased, both by the rough usage to which it had been subjected, and by the fact that so many of the garments were covered with a decoration of gold rosettes and bead-work.

Bead-work is in itself a complicated problem, and will perhaps tax an excavator's patience more than any other material with which he has to deal. There is so much of it. The Egyptians were passionately fond of beads, and it is by no means exceptional to find upon a single mummy an equipment consisting of a number of necklaces, two or three collars, a girdle or two, and a full set of bracelets and anklets. In such a case many thousands of beads will have been employed. Therein lies the test of patience,

159

¹ These, on our first entrance into the tomb, were mistaken for rolls of papyrus.

Work in the Laboratory

gold foil. The wood of which these separators was composed had entirely gone, leaving the gold foil shells; so I cut new pieces of wood to the shape, burnt out perforation holes with a red-hot needle, and covered the new bars with the original gold. Such restorations, based on actual evidence, are perfectly legitimate, and well worth the trouble. You will have secured for your museum, in place of a trayful of meaningless beads, or, worse still, a purely arbitrary and fanciful reconstruction, an object, attractive in itself, which has very considerable archaeological value.

Papyrus is frequently difficult to handle, and in its treatment more crimes have been committed than in any other branch of archaeology. If in fairly sound condition it should be wrapped in a damp cloth for a few hours, and then it can easily be straightened out under glass. Rolls that are torn and brittle, sure to separate into a number of small pieces during the process of unwrapping, should never be tackled unless you have plenty of time and space at your disposal. Careful and systematic work will ensure the correct spacing of almost all the fragments, whereas a desultory sorting, carried out in the intervals of other work, and perhaps by various hands, will never achieve a satisfactory result, and may end in the destruction of much valuable evidence. If only the Turin papyrus, for instance, had received careful treatment when it was first found, what a wealth of information it would have given us, and what heart-burnings we should have been saved!

Stone, as a rule, presents few difficulties in the field. Limestone will certainly contain salt, which

must be soaked out of it, but this is a problem that can be taken in hand later in the museum, and need not detain us here. In the same way faience, pottery, and metal objects can usually be left for later treatment. We are only concerned here with work that must be carried out on the spot.

Introduction

to his love of travel. He would suddenly dash off to Paris or Constantinople, Sweden, Italy or Berlin, for long or short periods, returning home equally unexpectedly, having collected pictures and books

Work in the Laboratory

We found eight in all, of the Tell el Amarna leaf and flower type, and it needed great care and patience to work out the exact arrangement of the different types of pendants. One of these is shown on Plate XXXIX, laid out loosely on ground glass to be photographed. They still need quite a lot of treatment to bring them back to their original colours, and there will have to be a certain amount of restoration of the broken and missing parts before they are ready for the final re-stringing. In one case we were lucky, for an elaborate three-string necklace, with a gilt pectoral at one end and a scarab-pendant at the other, lay flat upon the bottom of a box, so that we were able to remove it bead by bead, and re-string it on the spot in its exact original order (Plate XL).

Should you still be filled with doubt, start here, at the end, then go to the beginning. Kryptos is the painted casket. Inside, through layers of decayed treasure, there is a magnificent robe (K4) and that which rests below it (K5, K0).

162 THE TOMB OF TUT-ANKH-AMEN

away from it. Its outer face was completely covered with gesso; upon this prepared surface there were a series of brilliantly coloured and exquisitely painted designs—hunting scenes upon the curved panels of the lid, battle scenes upon the sides, and upon the ends representations of the king in lion form, trampling his enemies under his feet. The illustrations on Plates L–LIV give but a faint idea of the delicacy of the painting, which far surpasses anything of the kind that Egypt has yet produced. No photograph could do it justice, for even in the original a magnifying glass is essential to a due appreciation of the smaller details, such as the stippling of the lions' coats, or the decoration of the horses' trappings.

There is another remarkable thing about the painted scenes upon this box. The motives are Egyptian and the treatment Egyptian, and yet they leave an impression on your mind of something strangely non-Egyptian, and you cannot for the life of you explain exactly where the difference lies. They remind you of other things, too—the finest Persian miniatures, for instance—and there is a curious floating impression of Benozzo Gozzoli, due, maybe, to the gay little tufts of flowers which fill the vacant spaces. The contents of the box were a queer jumble. At the top there were a pair of rush and papyrus sandals, and a royal robe, completely covered with a decoration of beadwork and gold sequins. Beneath them were other decorated robes, one of which had had attached to it upwards of three thousand gold rosettes, three pairs of Court sandals elaborately

A SURVEY OF THE ANTECHAMBER 163

worked in gold, a gilt head-rest, and other miscellaneous objects. This was the first box we opened, and the ill-assorted nature of its contents—to say nothing of the manner in which they were crushed and bundled together—was a considerable puzzle to us. The reason of it became plain enough later, as we shall show in the following chapter.

Next, omitting some small unimportant objects, we came to the end (north) wall of the chamber. Here was the tantalising sealed doorway, and on either side of it, mounting guard over the entrance, stood the life-size wooden statues of the king already described. Strange and imposing figures these, even as we first saw them, surrounded and half concealed by other objects: as they stand now in the empty chamber, with nothing in front of them to distract the eye, and beyond them, through the opened door, the golden shrine half visible, they present an appearance that is almost painfully impressive. Originally they were shrouded in shawls of linen, and this, too, must have added to the effect. One other point about this end wall, and an interesting one. Unlike the other walls of the chamber, its whole surface was covered with plaster, and a close examination revealed the fact that from top to bottom it was but a blind, a mere partition wall.

Turning now to the long (west) wall of the chamber, we found the whole of the wall-space occupied by the three great animal-sided couches, curious pieces of furniture which we knew from illustrations in the tomb paintings, but of which we had never seen actual

PLATE L

SCENE IN MINIATURE PAINTING UPON THE RIGHT-HAND SIDE OF THE LID OF THE **PAINTED CASKET**, No. 21

In the centre we see the king in his chariot shooting desert fauna, among which can be identified gazelle, hartebeest, wild-ass, ostrich, and striped hyena, fleeing before His Majesty's hounds. Behind the king are represented his fan-bearers, courtiers and body-guard. In the field are depicted desert flora.

(See pp. 110-111.)

PLATE LI

SCENE IN MINIATURE PAINTING UPON THE LEFT-HAND SIDE OF THE LID OF THE **PAINTED CASKET**, No. 21

This is a similar composition to that in the preceding plate (L), but here Tut-ankh-Amen hunts lions and lionesses. The minuteness of detail, sense of movement, and agonized expression of the dying animals rank this miniature painting as the finest of its kind, far surpassing Persian examples.

(See pp. 110-111.)

